

JETRO Regional and Analysis Report New Arrivals Notice (July 16, 2026 Issue)

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Subject: JETRO Regional and Analysis Report New Arrivals Notice (July 16, 2026 Issue)

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We provide you with the latest information on JETRO's regional and analysis reports, which offer an independent perspective on political and economic trends in major countries and regions around the world. We hope you find these reports useful.

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[Special Feature] Opportunities in the European Market: Initiatives by Mid-sized and Small-to-Medium Enterprises <Additional Article>

For Japanese companies, particularly mid-sized and small-to-medium enterprises with limited human resources and capital, the European market often presents high barriers due to geographic distance and regulatory challenges. However, Europe is home to many consumers who recognize the value of high-value-added products at which Japanese companies excel, and brand strength built in Europe can be leveraged when entering other markets, making it an attractive market. This report introduces cases of mainly small and medium-sized enterprises operating in Europe, highlighting the appeal that Japanese companies find in the European market despite existing barriers, and methods for overcoming challenges.

<Additional Article>

◇Overcoming European Market Barriers with High Quality and Agility (Shibanumajozo, Ibaraki Prefecture)

[Special Feature] Business Cases in Africa <Additional Article>
Company Interviews and Developments Around TICAD9

As attention grows on economic cooperation between Japan and Africa, the 9th Tokyo International Conference on African Development (TICAD9) was held in Yokohama in August 2025. African business opportunities are expected not only for large companies with networks and financial resources, but also for small and medium-sized enterprises in various sectors. Moreover, in Africa, diverse approaches are possible depending on each country, including partnerships with established third-country companies such as European firms and local enterprises. This report introduces a wide range of business cases involving Japanese companies and local enterprises in Africa.

<Additional Article>

■Local African Company Cases

◇Tunisian Startup Upcycling Crustacean Shells

[Europe/Germany] 2025 German Passenger Car Market (Part 2)

Top Three Manufacturers See Increased EV Sales

The 2025 global EV sales (electric vehicles: battery electric vehicles (BEV) and plug-in hybrid vehicles (PHEV)) of the three major German automakers—the Volkswagen Group, BMW Group, and Mercedes-Benz Group—all showed year-on-year growth.

<Reprint> 2025 German Passenger Car Market (Part 1)

Production and New Registrations Slightly Up, Major Manufacturers Struggling Globally

[Asia/Malaysia] Current State of Sarawak (Part 1)

Energy Investment Concentration Progressing

Malaysia comprises Peninsular Malaysia and Borneo (East Malaysia). While the political and economic center is in the former, the latter has been increasing its presence in recent years. In particular, Sarawak State on Borneo is attracting energy companies from Japan and other countries, with the aim of developing it as a regional clean energy hub. Given growing attention to Sarawak, this report covers the situation in two parts focusing on energy. This first part introduces the characteristics of the Sarawak State government, energy policy, investment environment merits, and demerits.

[Europe/Poland]

New Registrations Reach Record High, EV Market Expands Driven by Subsidies

Poland's automotive market is entering a major transition period with simultaneous "production contraction" and "market expansion." In 2025, passenger car production fell sharply by 52.6% year-on-year, while new car registrations reached a record high. Behind this are solid domestic demand, expanding corporate demand, and rapid EV market growth. Particularly noteworthy is accelerating electrification. Bolstered by government purchase subsidies, BEV registrations increased 2.6 times year-on-year, with Chinese manufacturers like MG and Jaecoo surging, causing shifts in market structure. However, challenges remain in charging infrastructure development and compliance with European standards. While the production sector faces headwinds from the European automotive industry, investments by Volkswagen, Toyota, and Foxconn in the EV and digital sectors are expanding, with Poland evolving from a manufacturing base to a Central and Eastern European automotive hub encompassing development and service functions. Future developments are noteworthy for understanding automotive industry restructuring and electrification trends.

[Asia/China] PILOT Growing by Capturing Student Demand: Local Strategy in Shenzhen

PILOT, a long-established Japanese writing instrument manufacturer, manufactures and sells writing instruments including fountain pens, ballpoint pens, and highlighters. Having developed new products like the erasable ballpoint pen "Friction," the company has

focused on overseas expansion, with its writing instruments now sold and used in over 190 countries and regions worldwide. Baile Trading (Shenzhen) (hereinafter, PILOT Shenzhen), established in 2004 in Shenzhen, Guangdong Province as a sales company in China, celebrates its 22nd anniversary in 2026. JETRO interviewed Satoshi Hato, General Manager of PILOT Shenzhen.